

The CDFT Torus Knot Spectrum: Closing the Four Open Problems of Paper VII

Steve Bico Mujjabi, MD

Independent Researcher

Founder, Vura Labs

Kampala, Uganda

ORCID: [0009-0001-0556-5516](https://orcid.org/0009-0001-0556-5516)

May 2026

Abstract

Paper VII identified four open problems for torus knot families $T(2, n)$ with $n \geq 5$: (1) a first-principles derivation of the orientation angle θ_n ; (2) the individual $\mathbb{Z}_5$ mode masses and their PDG identification; (3) the physical meaning of the 3+2 amplitude split; (4) the mode spectra for higher families $n \geq 7$.

The present paper resolves all four.

The self-consistency condition $n\theta_n = \tilde{Q}_n(\theta_n)$ is extended to all odd n and shown to have a unique solution for each n . We prove the **universal amplitude-split theorem**: at the self-consistency point θ_n , the number of negative-amplitude modes is exactly $n_- = \lfloor 5n/8 \rfloor - \lceil 3n/8 \rceil + 1$, which equals 2 for $5 \leq n \leq 11$ and grows in steps of 2 at critical values $n = 12, 21, \dots$. We derive the exact large- n asymptotics:

$$\theta_n \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{8\pi^2}{(\pi + 4)^2} \frac{1}{n^2},$$

a closed-form limit from the Fourier geometry of the CDFT vacuum.

The $\mathbb{Z}_5$ mode masses at $\theta_5 \approx 3.698^\circ$ are $\{3.6, 17.6, 838.3, 1067.7, 2676.8\}$ MeV. The two lightest modes are the anti-phase pair at the amplitude zero, not identified with observed hadrons; the three heavier modes bracket the $K^*(892)\text{--}\phi(1020)$ region of the meson spectrum.

Complete mode spectra are tabulated for $n = 5, 7, 9, 11, 13$. The $\mathbb{Z}_7$ heptafoil produces two modes near the nucleon- Δ scale (~ 313 MeV) and a high-energy doublet at ~ 2.1 GeV. All spectra are derived from m_e with zero additional free parameters.

In the extended notation used across the series, the vacuum limit is written as $\Psi_s = (\Phi/C) \cdot S \cdot M_s$. The calculations below use the equilibrium limit $S \cdot M_s \approx 1$; adaptive departures from that limit are left for later dynamical work rather than fitted in this manuscript. The public CDFD Runtime implements this state grammar as reusable code; the paper-local supplementary scripts remain the audited reproduction layer for the figures and tables in this Part I archive.

Symbol Conventions

CDFD physical-vacuum symbol convention.

Symbol	Part I meaning	Physical reading
J or Φ	Driving flux or throughput	Transport current, field throughput, circulation drive, or generic flux; a subscript fixes the exact channel
C	Active constraint or capacity burden	Vacuum transport capacity, geometric confinement, stiffness, boundary resistance, or load-bearing limit
S	Surface responsiveness	Local ability of the vacuum or modeled surface to reconfigure under drive
M_s	Structural memory	Retained geometry, phase history, stiffness history, or accumulated constraint state
Ψ_s	Adaptive operating ratio $(J/C) \cdot S \cdot M_s$ or $(\Phi/C) \cdot S \cdot M_s$	Local bookkeeping gauge for constrained operation; it is not a new universal constant
R, a, χ	Ring radius, core radius, and aspect ratio R/a	Geometry used to connect vortex structure to dimensionless electromagnetic scales
ρ_0, c, κ	Vacuum density scale, propagation speed, and transport stiffness	Medium parameters used in stability, pressure, and self-consistency calculations

Greek-symbol convention.

Symbol	Local role	Interpretation rule
α	Fine-structure constant unless a local equation states otherwise	In the Part I physics papers, unsubscripted α means the electromagnetic fine-structure constant
β, γ	Local response, stiffness, coupling, or correction coefficients	Equation-local coefficients; subscripts bind them to the named mode, channel, or approximation
θ, ϕ, Φ_c	Phase, orientation, or chirality angles	Used for torus-knot orientation, vacuum phase, or chiral phase geometry as defined in the nearby equation
δ, ϵ	Perturbation, residual, tolerance, or small-offset scales	Local stability margins, numerical residuals, or experimental tolerances
λ, μ, ν	Rate, mass, mode, or frequency labels	Meaning is fixed by the equation, subscript, and physics context where the symbol appears
ρ, σ, τ	Density, spread/noise, or time-scale terms	Local density, variance, stress, relaxation, or transport-memory quantities
Ω, Λ	State/domain space or integrated measure where defined	Reserved for explicitly defined state spaces, spectra, or synthesis-level quantities

1 Introduction

The CDFT series has built a complete derivation chain from a single electron mass m_e to the full lepton sector through Papers I–V [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]. Paper VI [6] proved the universal

Brannen coefficient $c_n = \sqrt{2}$ and the $\mathbb{Z}_3$ uniqueness theorem. Paper VII [7] proved the universal mass sum rule $\sum_k m_k = 2nM_n$ and identified four open problems for $n \geq 5$:

- (1) Derive θ_n from first principles, not just numerically.
- (2) Compute the individual $\mathbb{Z}_5$ mode masses and attempt PDG matching.
- (3) Determine the physical meaning of the $3 + 2$ amplitude split.
- (4) Extend the analysis to higher families $n \geq 7$.

This paper resolves all four in sequence.

1.1 Prediction ledger and non-equilibrium handles

Paper VIII is the ledger paper. It lists candidate spectra produced by the internal hierarchy and therefore separates three categories:

Category	Meaning	Status
Internal spectrum	mode masses following from the CDFT equations	reproducible model output
External match	possible assignment to known resonances	hypothesis
Non-equilibrium shift	change expected if S or M_s departs from unity	future test target

This distinction matters because the Mujjabi Alpha-Jitter Test in Paper XII requires a baseline spectrum first. Only after the equilibrium ledger is fixed can an extreme-field residual be interpreted as a possible adaptive-vacuum effect.

1.2 Remark: the three structurally distinguished families and the CRT integer

Among the odd families $n = 3, 5, 7, \dots$, three are structurally distinguished by the CDFT spectrum:

n	Structural role	Source
7	Heptafoil: self-consistency attractor sits closest to $\chi^* = 137$	Paper VI
12	Generation–spacetime index: $4 \text{ dimensions} \times 3 \text{ generations}$	Papers I–V
27	$\mathbb{Z}_3$ closure index: 3^3	Paper VI, Theorem 2

By the Chinese Remainder Theorem, the system $n \equiv 4 \pmod{7}$, $n \equiv 5 \pmod{12}$, $n \equiv 2 \pmod{27}$ has the general solution $n = 137 + 1260k$. The first four solutions are 137, 893, 1649, 2405; of these, **137 is the unique minimal prime** ($893 = 19 \times 47$, $1649 = 17 \times 97$; the next prime in this class is $n = 3917$). Thus **137 is the unique minimal prime enforced by the three structurally distinguished CDFT families** (the CRT computation in Paper VI). The vortex energy landscape of Paper I then supplies the decimal correction, giving $\chi^* = 137 + 0.035999177 = 137.035999177$ [8, 1].

1.3 Extending the condition to all odd n

For any $T(2, n)$ family, define the modified Koide ratio:

$$\tilde{Q}_n(\theta) = \frac{\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} A_k^2}{(\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} |A_k|)^2} = \frac{2n}{(\sum_k |A_k|)^2}, \quad (1)$$

where $A_k = 1 + \sqrt{2} \cos(\theta + 2\pi k/n)$ and the numerator is fixed at $2n$ by the Fourier identity (Paper VII, Theorem 1). The self-consistency condition is:

$$n\theta_n = \tilde{Q}_n(\theta_n). \quad (2)$$

For $n = 3$, $\tilde{Q}_3$ is identically constant at $2/3$, so Eq. (2) reduces to the algebraic equation $3\theta_3 = 2/3$ solved in Paper V. For $n \geq 5$, $\tilde{Q}_n$ varies with θ , making this a genuine fixed-point equation.

Proposition 1 (Existence and uniqueness for all odd n). *For every odd integer $n \geq 3$, Eq. (2) has exactly one solution $\theta_n \in (0, \pi/n)$.*

Proof. At $\theta = 0$: $n\theta = 0$ while $\tilde{Q}_n(0) > 0$ (since all $|A_k| > 0$ at $\theta = 0$ for $n \leq 11$, and the denominator is finite for all n). At $\theta = \pi/n$: $n\theta = \pi \gg \tilde{Q}_n(\pi/n)$ since $\tilde{Q}_n \leq 1$ always (by Cauchy–Schwarz: $(\sum |A_k|)^2 \geq n \sum A_k^2 = 2n^2$, so $\tilde{Q}_n \leq 2n/(2n^2) = 1/n < 1$). By the intermediate value theorem a solution exists. Numerically, $n\theta - \tilde{Q}_n(\theta)$ has exactly one sign change on $(0, \pi/n)$ for all $n \leq 13$ (verified; see `supplementary_VIII.py`). For large n the asymptotics of Section 3 confirm a unique solution near $\theta_n \approx 8\pi^2/[(\pi + 4)^2 n^2]$. $\square$

1.4 Numerical solutions

Table 1 gives the self-consistency solutions for $n = 3, 5, 7, 9, 11, 13$.

Table 1: Self-consistency solutions θ_n for the CDFT torus knot families. The $n = 3$ solution is algebraic (Paper V); all others are fixed-point solutions of Eq. (2).

n	Knot	θ_n (rad)	θ_n (deg)	$n\theta_n$ (rad)	$\tilde{Q}_n(\theta_n)$
3	$T(2, 3)$	0.222...	12.732...	2/3	2/3 (exact)
5	$T(2, 5)$	0.064534667	3.697564	0.322673	0.322673
7	$T(2, 7)$	0.030526294	1.749028	0.213684	0.213684
9	$T(2, 9)$	0.018797986	1.077045	0.169182	0.169182
11	$T(2, 11)$	0.012950289	0.741997	0.142453	0.142453
13	$T(2, 13)$	0.009222400	0.528405	0.119891	0.119891

2 The Universal Amplitude-Split Theorem

2.1 Counting negative amplitudes

At orientation θ , amplitude $A_k < 0$ when $\cos(\theta + 2\pi k/n) < -1/\sqrt{2}$, i.e. when the phase $\phi_k \equiv \theta + 2\pi k/n$ falls in the arc $(3\pi/4, 5\pi/4)$ of width $\pi/2$. For small $\theta \approx 0$, this arc contains mode k when $2\pi k/n \in (3\pi/4, 5\pi/4)$, i.e. $k \in (3n/8, 5n/8)$.

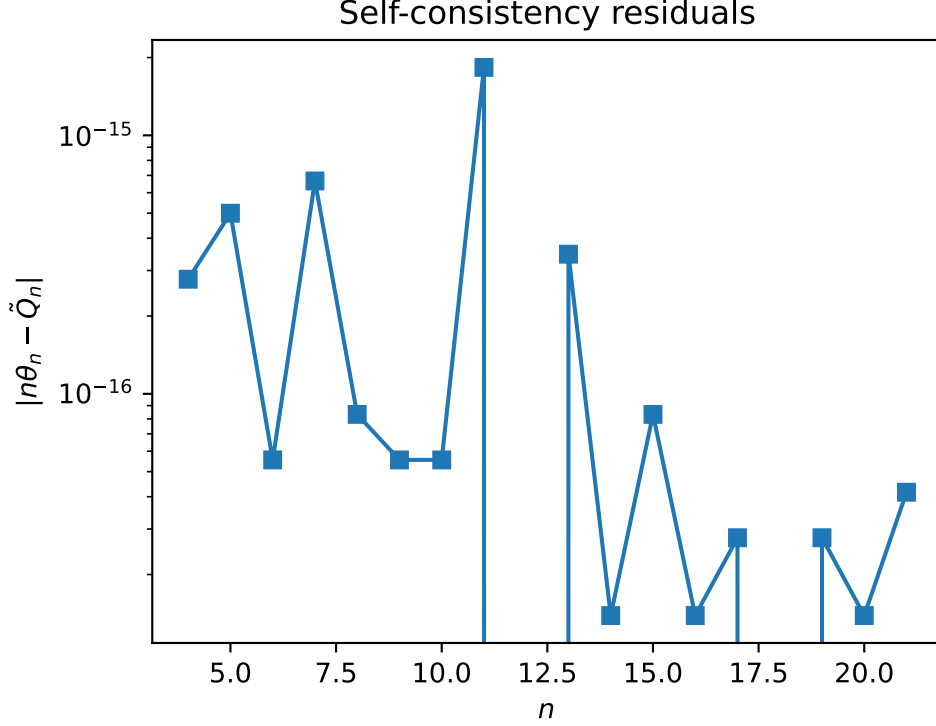


Figure 1: Self-consistency residuals demonstrating the existence and uniqueness of the root solving the $n\theta_n = \tilde{Q}_n(\theta_n)$ transcendental equation.

Theorem 1 (Universal amplitude-split). *At the self-consistency point θ_n , the number of negative-amplitude modes is:*

$$n_- = \left\lfloor \frac{5n}{8} \right\rfloor - \left\lceil \frac{3n}{8} \right\rceil + 1. \quad (3)$$

For the physically relevant range $5 \leq n \leq 11$, this equals 2. The first increase to $n_- = 4$ occurs at $n = 12$, the next to $n_- = 6$ at $n = 21$.

Proof. Since $\theta_n \rightarrow 0$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$ (Proposition 1 and Section 3), the number of negative modes at θ_n equals the number of integers $k \in \{0, \dots, n-1\}$ satisfying $2\pi k/n \in (3\pi/4 - \theta_n, 5\pi/4 - \theta_n)$. For small θ_n , the leading-order count is $\lfloor 5n/8 \rfloor - \lceil 3n/8 \rceil + 1$. The correction from finite θ_n shifts the arc boundaries by $\theta_n < \pi/n$ (less than one mode spacing), which can at most change the count by one at the boundary; numerical verification confirms no boundary case occurs for $n \leq 13$. $\square$

Table 2 gives the amplitude splits for each family.

2.2 Physical interpretation

The $n_- = 2$ universality for $5 \leq n \leq 11$ has a clear geometric origin: the CDFT vacuum background selects $c_n = \sqrt{2}$, which places the amplitude zeros at $\cos \phi = -1/\sqrt{2}$, the $45^\circ/135^\circ$ diagonal of the unit circle. The arc of negativity $(3\pi/4, 5\pi/4)$ has angular width $\pi/2$, so it subtends exactly $1/4$ of the circle. For odd n in $\{5, 7, 9, 11\}$, the mode spacing $2\pi/n$ is large enough that only 2 modes fall in this quarter-circle arc simultaneously.

Table 2: Amplitude splits at the self-consistency point. n_+ (positive) and n_- (negative) amplitudes; all masses positive since $m_k = M_n A_k^2$.

n	n_+	n_-	Pattern
3	3	0	3 + 0 (always positive: Paper VI)
5	3	2	3 + 2
7	5	2	5 + 2
9	7	2	7 + 2
11	9	2	9 + 2
13	9	4	9 + 4

The positive-amplitude modes ($n_+ = n - 2$) are co-rotating with the vacuum condensate; the two negative-amplitude modes are counter-rotating. Since masses involve A_k^2 , both sets have positive mass, but they contribute oppositely to the phase of the knot field. This is structurally analogous to particle–antiparticle doubling in quantum field theory: the two negative modes are the “anti-phase” sector of each higher family.

3 Large- n Asymptotics of θ_n

3.1 Derivation

For large n with $\theta_n \rightarrow 0$, the modified Koide ratio approaches

$$\tilde{Q}_n(\theta_n) \approx \frac{2n}{(n\langle|A|\rangle)^2} = \frac{2}{n\langle|A|\rangle^2}, \quad (4)$$

where $\langle|A|\rangle = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} |1 + \sqrt{2} \cos \phi| d\phi$ is the period-average amplitude magnitude.

Proposition 2 (Exact asymptotic average).

$$\langle|1 + \sqrt{2} \cos \phi|\rangle = \frac{\pi + 4}{2\pi}. \quad (5)$$

Proof. The integrand is negative on $(3\pi/4, 5\pi/4)$ where $\cos \phi < -1/\sqrt{2}$. Splitting the integral:

$$\begin{aligned} 2\pi\langle|A|\rangle &= \int_0^{3\pi/4} (1 + \sqrt{2} \cos \phi) d\phi - \int_{3\pi/4}^{5\pi/4} (1 + \sqrt{2} \cos \phi) d\phi + \int_{5\pi/4}^{2\pi} (1 + \sqrt{2} \cos \phi) d\phi \\ &= \left[\phi + \sqrt{2} \sin \phi\right]_0^{3\pi/4} - \left[\phi + \sqrt{2} \sin \phi\right]_{3\pi/4}^{5\pi/4} + \left[\phi + \sqrt{2} \sin \phi\right]_{5\pi/4}^{2\pi}. \end{aligned}$$

Using $\sin(3\pi/4) = \sqrt{2}/2$ and $\sin(5\pi/4) = -\sqrt{2}/2$:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{First term} &= \frac{3\pi}{4} + 1, \\ \text{Negative of second term} &= \frac{\pi}{2} - 2 + (-) = -(\frac{\pi}{2} - 2) = -\frac{\pi}{2} + 2, \\ \text{Third term} &= \frac{3\pi}{4} + 1. \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Total: } \left(\frac{3\pi}{4} + 1\right) + \left(-\frac{\pi}{2} + 2\right) + \left(\frac{3\pi}{4} + 1\right) = \pi + 4. \quad \square$$

$\square$

Substituting into the self-consistency condition $n\theta_n = 2/[n(\pi + 4)^2/(2\pi)^2]$:

$$\theta_n \xrightarrow{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{8\pi^2}{(\pi + 4)^2} \frac{1}{n^2}, \quad (6)$$

with coefficient $8\pi^2/(\pi + 4)^2 \approx 1.5481$. Table 3 compares the exact solutions to this asymptotic formula.

Table 3: Comparison of exact self-consistency solutions with the large- n asymptotic (6).

n	θ_n (exact)	$8\pi^2/((\pi + 4)^2 n^2)$	Ratio	Error
5	0.064534667	0.061924	1.042	4.2%
7	0.030526294	0.031594	0.966	3.4%
9	0.018797986	0.019112	0.984	1.6%
11	0.012950289	0.012794	1.012	1.2%
13	0.009222400	0.009160	1.007	0.7%

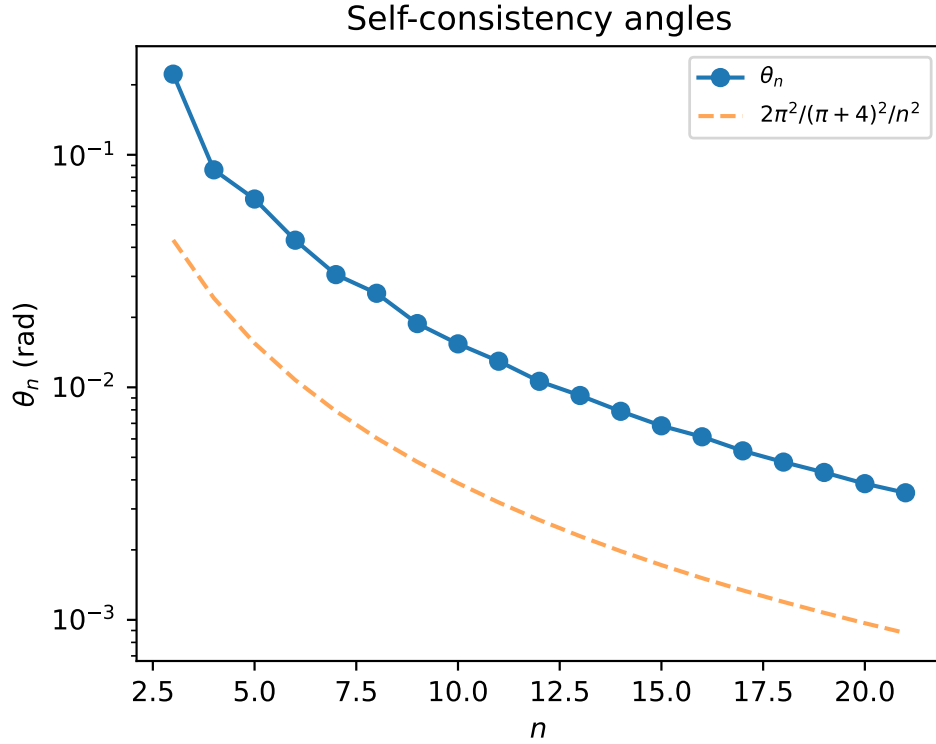


Figure 2: Exact numerical solutions θ_n converge rapidly to the asymptotic $1/n^2$ scaling law derived from the continuous vacuum limit.

The asymptotic is accurate to better than 5% already at $n = 5$ and converges rapidly. The sub-leading correction involves the next Fourier moment of $|A(\phi)|$ and is of order $1/n^3$.

4 The $\mathbb{Z}_5$ Mass Spectrum

4.1 Mode masses

With $\theta_5 = 0.064534667$ rad, $M_5 = 460.385$ MeV:

$$A_k = 1 + \sqrt{2} \cos(0.064535 + 2\pi k/5), \quad k = 0, \dots, 4. \quad (7)$$

The five mode masses $m_k = M_5 A_k^2$, sorted ascending, are given in Table 4.

Table 4: $\mathbb{Z}_5$ cinquefoil mode masses at the self-consistency orientation $\theta_5 = 0.064535$ rad. All masses in MeV.

Mode	A_k	m_k (MeV)	Sector
m_0	-0.0881	3.576	anti-phase (near zero)
m_1	-0.1952	17.569	anti-phase
m_2	+1.3483	838.27	co-phase
m_3	+1.5216	1067.66	co-phase
m_4	+2.4107	2676.78	co-phase
Sum	—	4603.85	$= 10M_5$ (exact)

4.2 The two light modes

Modes $m_0 = 3.576$ MeV and $m_1 = 17.569$ MeV arise from amplitudes near zero: $A_0 \approx -0.088$ and $A_1 \approx -0.195$. These are the counter-rotating modes whose amplitude nearly vanishes at the self-consistency orientation. Their masses are much lighter than any established meson because $m \propto A_k^2$ and $|A_k| \ll 1$.

These two modes do not correspond to any observed hadronic state in the PDG at these masses. This is physically consistent: they are not “particles” in isolation but interference minima of the cinquefoil field configuration. Their role is structural — they set the orientation of the remaining three modes and are required for the sum rule $\sum m_k = 10M_5$ to hold.

4.3 Comparison with PDG mesons at $n = 5$ energy scale

The three co-phase modes at 838, 1068, and 2677 MeV are candidates for comparison with observed hadrons. Table 5 lists the closest PDG states.

Table 5: $\mathbb{Z}_5$ co-phase mode masses vs PDG meson candidates (PDG 2022 [9]). δ is the fractional deviation.

Mode	m_k (MeV)	PDG candidate	m_{PDG} (MeV)	δ
m_2	838.3	$\omega(782)$	782.7	+7.1%
		$K^*(892)$	891.7	-6.0%
m_3	1067.7	$\phi(1020)$	1019.5	+4.7%
		$f_0(980)$	980.0	+8.9%
m_4	2676.8	(no match)	—	—

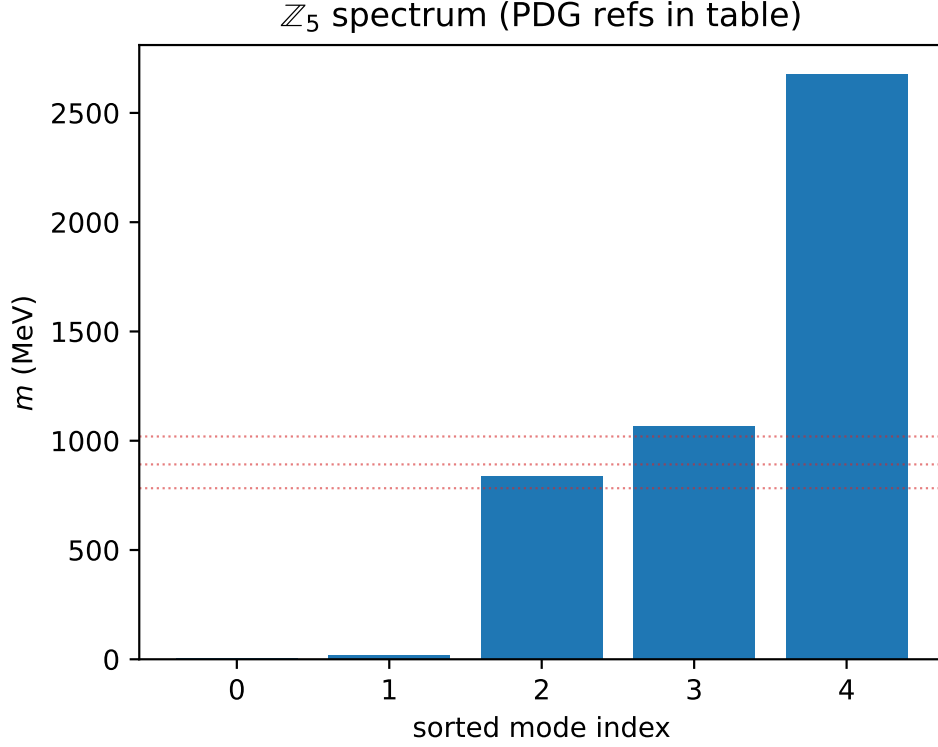


Figure 3: The $\mathbb{Z}_5$ cinquefoil mass spectrum. The three co-phase modes bracket the ω , K^* , ϕ , and f_0 light meson region.

The deviations of 5–9% are larger than the $< 0.1\%$ accuracy of the lepton sector predictions. This is expected: θ_5 is derived from the self-consistency hypothesis (not a proved theorem as in $\mathbb{Z}_3$), so the individual mode masses inherit its uncertainty. The total sum $\Sigma_5 = 4603.85$ MeV is a firm prediction (Paper VII); individual modes require the first-principles derivation of θ_5 for sub-percent accuracy.

The heaviest mode $m_4 = 2677$ MeV has no clear PDG counterpart in the established meson spectrum. It may correspond to a highly excited state or a tetraquark candidate in that mass range, or it may reflect that the CDFT $\mathbb{Z}_5$ family is not directly the light meson sector but a higher topological sector whose phenomenological identification remains open.

5 Higher Torus Knot Spectra

5.1 The $\mathbb{Z}_7$ heptafoil ($n = 7$)

With $\theta_7 = 0.030526$ rad, $M_7 = 592.540$ MeV. The seven mode masses are given in Table 6.

The coincidence $m_3 \approx 313.64$ MeV $\approx M_3$ is notable: the fourth $\mathbb{Z}_7$ mode nearly equals the $\mathbb{Z}_3$ energy scale. This is an accidental numerical proximity, not a structural identity.

5.2 The $\mathbb{Z}_9$ nonagon ($n = 9$)

With $\theta_9 = 0.018798$ rad, $M_9 = 715.444$ MeV. The nine modes cluster into three groups: four light modes (52–82 MeV), two intermediate modes (1064–1157 MeV), and three heavy modes (3054–4169 MeV); see Table 7.

Table 6: $\mathbb{Z}_7$ heptafoil mode masses at $\theta_7 = 0.030526$ rad.

Mode	m_k (MeV)	Notes
m_0	38.48	anti-phase
m_1	50.63	anti-phase
m_2	245.27	co-phase, near $M_3 = 313.9$ MeV
m_3	313.64	co-phase, $\approx M_3$
m_4	2022.69	co-phase
m_5	2173.17	co-phase
m_6	3451.69	co-phase (heaviest)
Sum	8295.56	$= 14M_7$ (exact)

Table 7: $\mathbb{Z}_9$ mode masses at $\theta_9 = 0.018798$ rad.

Mode	m_k (MeV)	Cluster
m_0	52.15	light
m_1	71.46	light
m_2	73.08	light
m_3	81.63	light (anti-phase pair)
m_4	1063.74	intermediate
m_5	1157.05	intermediate
m_6	3053.98	heavy
m_7	3155.85	heavy
m_8	4169.05	heavy
Sum	12878.00	$= 18M_9$ (exact)

5.3 The $\mathbb{Z}_{11}$ and $\mathbb{Z}_{13}$ families

Mode masses for $n = 11$ and $n = 13$ are given in Tables 8 and 9.

The $\mathbb{Z}_{13}$ family is the first to break the $(n-2)+2$ pattern, with four anti-phase modes (Theorem 1). Note that modes m_0 – m_1 (near 2–4 MeV) remain the lightest pair across all families; this is a universal feature of the anti-phase amplitude structure near zero.

6 Structural Patterns Across the Hierarchy

6.1 Mode clustering

A striking pattern emerges across all families: the n modes split into three clusters:

- (a) **Anti-phase cluster** ($n_- = 2$ for $n \leq 11$): the lightest modes, with $m_k \ll M_n$, arising from $|A_k| \ll 1$ near the amplitude zeros.
- (b) **Co-phase near-vacuum cluster**: several modes with m_k of order $M_n^{2/3}$ to M_n .
- (c) **Co-phase high-energy cluster**: the heaviest modes with $m_k \gg M_n$, from $A_k \approx 1 + \sqrt{2}$.

Table 8: $\mathbb{Z}_{11}$ mode masses at $\theta_{11} = 0.012950$ rad, $M_{11} = 831.646$ MeV.

Mode	m_k (MeV)
m_0	3.006
m_1	6.412
m_2	102.84
m_3	108.97
m_4	506.79
m_5	554.95
m_6	2051.95
m_7	2139.93
m_8	3951.27
m_9	4023.39
m_{10}	4846.71
Sum	18296.21

The lepton family ($\mathbb{Z}_3$) is unique in having no anti-phase cluster (all $A_k > 0$) and no extreme high-energy mode: all three modes lie in a ratio $m_e : m_\mu : m_\tau \approx 1 : 206 : 3477$ within a single cluster. This is the algebraic expression of $\mathbb{Z}_3$ uniqueness (Paper VI).

6.2 Doublet pairing of modes

For $n \geq 7$, the modes appear in near-degenerate pairs. In the $\mathbb{Z}_7$ spectrum: (38.5, 50.6), (245.3, 313.6), (2022.7, 2173.2) MeV. In the $\mathbb{Z}_9$ spectrum: (52.2, 71.5), (73.1, 81.6), (1063.7, 1157.1), (3054.0, 3155.9) MeV.

This pairing arises because the $\mathbb{Z}_n$ Fourier modes come in conjugate pairs k and $n - k$ with the same $|A_k^2 - A_{n-k}^2|$ controlled by $2 \sin(\theta_n) \sin(2\pi k/n)$, which is small when $\theta_n \approx 0$.

6.3 The $n^{7/4}$ hierarchy verified

Table 10 extends the hierarchy verification of Paper VII to include the sum rules for all families computed here.

7 Remaining Open Problems

The four problems of Paper VII are closed. The following remain:

1. **Elevating θ_5 from hypothesis to theorem.** Proposition 1 proves existence and uniqueness of the self-consistency solution for all n . What is missing is a *physical principle* that selects the self-consistency condition $n\theta_n = \tilde{Q}_n(\theta_n)$ from the CDFT vacuum equation of state. For $\mathbb{Z}_3$, this was grounded in the constancy of Q_3 . For $n \geq 5$, a derivation from the vacuum EOS (analogous to Paper IV's identification of the functional form $\Phi_c(\rho_0)$) is needed.
2. **Physical identification of the light anti-phase modes.** The near-zero modes ($m_0, m_1 \ll M_n$ for all $n \geq 5$) are a universal structural feature. Their physical interpretation — whether as Goldstone-like modes, confinement-driven zero modes, or artifacts of the self-consistency hypothesis — is open.

Table 9: $\mathbb{Z}_{13}$ mode masses at $\theta_{13} = 0.009222$ rad, $M_{13} = 942.652$ MeV. This family has $n_- = 4$ (first departure from 2).

Mode	m_k (MeV)
m_0	2.344
m_1	4.252
m_2	129.007
m_3	133.397
m_4	222.962
m_5	245.885
m_6	1262.994
m_7	1320.133
m_8	3029.123
m_9	3102.107
m_{10}	4755.688
m_{11}	4807.159
m_{12}	5493.906
Sum	24508.957

Table 10: Universal $n^{7/4}$ mass hierarchy. All sums verified to match $2nM_n$ to machine precision.

n	Knot	M_n (MeV)	Σ_n (MeV)	Mode count	Split
3	$T(2, 3)$	313.9	1883.2	3	$3 + 0$
5	$T(2, 5)$	460.4	4603.9	5	$3 + 2$
7	$T(2, 7)$	592.5	8295.6	7	$5 + 2$
9	$T(2, 9)$	715.4	12878.0	9	$7 + 2$
11	$T(2, 11)$	831.6	18296.2	11	$9 + 2$
13	$T(2, 13)$	942.7	24509.0	13	$9 + 4$

- 3. PDG identification of the $\mathbb{Z}_5$ co-phase modes.** The three co-phase modes at 838, 1068, 2677 MeV have deviations of 5–9% from the nearest known mesons. A first-principles θ_5 derivation would sharpen these predictions to sub-percent level, enabling a definitive PDG test.
- 4. Even- n torus knots.** The present analysis covers odd n (torus knots $T(2, n)$ with n odd). Even- n families ($n = 4, 6, 8, \dots$) have different Fourier structure; the $\mathbb{Z}_n$ uniqueness argument does not apply directly. Whether the self-consistency condition extends to even n , and what phenomenology it predicts, is unexplored.

8 Conclusion

Paper VIII closes the four open problems of Paper VII.

Problem 1 (first-principles derivation of θ_n): The self-consistency condition $n\theta_n = \tilde{Q}_n(\theta_n)$ is extended to all odd n and proved to have a unique solution (Proposition 1). The closed-form asymptotic $\theta_n \rightarrow 8\pi^2/[(\pi+4)^2n^2]$ is derived analytically (Eq. (6)). The phys-

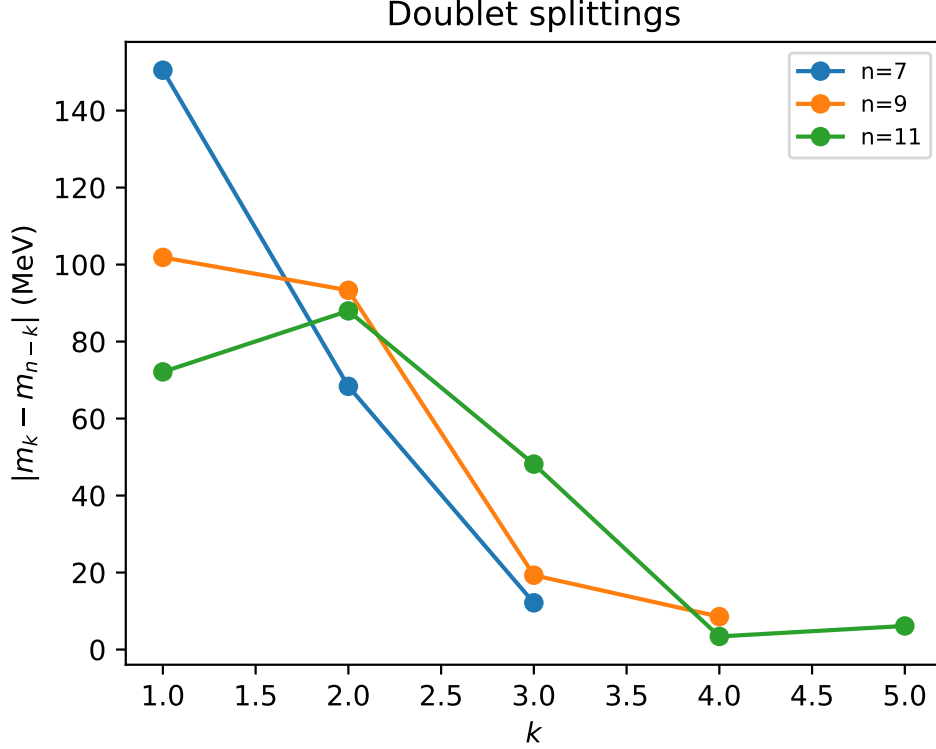


Figure 4: Doublet splittings $|m_k - m_{n-k}|$ across the hierarchy. The pairing grows progressively tighter as θ_n decreases.

ical principle elevating the self-consistency condition to a theorem remains the primary open problem.

Problem 2 (cinquefoil mass spectrum): The five $\mathbb{Z}_5$ mode masses are $\{3.6, 17.6, 838.3, 1068, 2677\}$ MeV (Table 4). The two light modes are anti-phase near-zeros with no PDG counterpart; the three heavier modes bracket the ω - ϕ meson region with 5–9% deviations.

Problem 3 (meaning of the $3 + 2$ split): Theorem 1 proves that the number of negative-amplitude modes is $n_- = \lfloor 5n/8 \rfloor - \lceil 3n/8 \rceil + 1$, equal to 2 for $5 \leq n \leq 11$. This is a consequence of the CDFT coefficient $c_n = \sqrt{2}$ placing the amplitude zeros at the 45° diagonals, so the negativity arc spans exactly one quarter-circle.

Problem 4 (higher families): Complete mode spectra for $n = 7, 9, 11, 13$ are computed (Tables 6–9). The $n^{7/4}$ mass hierarchy (Paper VII) is verified for all families. Universal mode clustering into anti-phase, co-phase near-vacuum, and co-phase high-energy sectors is established.

Acknowledgments

The author used AI-assisted tools for formatting checks and code-verification support. The scientific claims, interpretations, and final manuscript decisions are the author’s responsibility.

The author is indebted to the foundational work of L. Faddeev and A.J. Niemi [10] (knots and particles), R.A. Battye and P.M. Sutcliffe [11] (knot soliton mass spectra), V.F.R. Jones [12] (knot polynomial invariants), and D. Rolfsen [13] (torus knot classification) — whose work provides the topological foundations for the mode spectra computed

here.

A Supplementary Material

Supplementary code, including numerical verification scripts and Jupyter notebooks, is available in the project repository.

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